

The Clock That Sings

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Mimi the mouse was scared of the hallway clock. Every hour it went BONG. The sound was loud and deep. It shook her whiskers. She felt frightened.

At bedtime, she covered her ears. "I do not like the clock," she told her father. "It shouts too loud."

Her father smiled. "Come," he said. "Let us meet the clock properly."



They tiptoed to the hallway. The big clock stood tall and wooden. Its face was round and kind. Its hands moved slowly. Tick-tock, tick-tock.

"It does not look shouty," said Mimi. She felt a little braver.

"Clocks are like singers," said Father. "They sing the hours all day long. But even singers get tired. Watch what happens at bedtime."



Just then, the clock began to chime. But it was not a loud BONG. It was soft and slow. Bong... bong... It sounded like a lullaby.

"Tick-tock, soft and low, time for little mice to go," sang Father quietly.

Mimi listened. The clock's song was gentle. It was telling the house that bedtime had come. It was not shouting at all. It was singing everyone to sleep.

"Tick-tock, soft and low, time for little mice to go," sang Father again.



Mimi yawned. The clock's lullaby was working. She felt drowsy and safe. The clock was not scary. It was a friend helping her sleep.

They went back to bed. Father tucked her in. Through the wall, she could hear the clock. Tick-tock, tick-tock. Soft and low.

"Tick-tock, soft and low, time for little mice to go," sang Father one last time.



Mimi closed her eyes. She imagined the clock singing to the whole house. To the sleepy spoons in the kitchen. To the drowsy books on the shelf. To every little mouse in every little bed.

Her breathing grew slow. Her tail curled softly. The clock kept its gentle beat. It would sing all night, watching over her dreams.

Sleep now, little mouse. The clock is singing you to sleep. Its song will keep time with your dreams until morning.

Moral: Loud things are less scary once you understand their gentle purpose.

The End